THE MARKET BRIEF DAILY / AI RESEARCH

# Two desks. One research briefing.

Source cycle: 2026-10-17T17:40:54.920488+00:00 | Exported: 2026-10-18T14:53:26.728265+00:00

AURORA: The captured 16 October equity session shows technology weakness, but its cause remains unresolved.

TradingAgents: Foldable demand/delivery-slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are unverified publisher claims.

Research status: saved review. A separate, exact-account-bound MT5 demo supervisor may act only after its own proposal, risk review and broker checks. This report does not grant live-money execution permission. Hypotheses are not approved allocations.

## The macro dashboard

| SERIES | VALUE | OBSERVATION |
|---|---|---|
| Fed target | 3.75–4.00% | 2026-10-17 |
| Bank of England | 3.75% | 2026-10-15 |
| US 10-year yield | 5.10% | 2026-10-15 |
| VIX | 16.46 | 2026-10-15 |
| US high-yield spread | 3.23% | 2026-10-15 |
| US CPI · year on year | 3.72% | 2026-09-01 |
| UK CPI · year on year | 3.10% | 2026 AUG |
| US unemployment | 4.20% | 2026-09-01 |

Observation periods differ from release dates. Equity history is vendor-supplied and delayed; charts show market prices, not fund performance.

# Shared research workflow

AURORA discovery or standing company watch → shared data check → TradingAgents investigation → committee inbox → subsequent AURORA portfolio review.

Case AAPL / complete. Additional sources captured 2026-10-18T13:18:10.963786+00:00. AURORA source cycle 2026-10-17T17:40:54.920488+00:00. These are distinct snapshots; the earlier committee decision has not been revised.

189 case records captured; 83 distinct records logged in saved worker contexts. Delivery does not certify full-source reading or factual verification.

## Coverage and required follow-up

| Input | State | Captured / supplied |
|---|---|---|
| Completed price and share-volume history | available | 2 / 2 |
| Dated RSI, MACD and moving averages | available | 1 / 1 |
| Verified issuer profile | available | 1 / 1 |
| Income, cash flow and balance-sheet inputs | partial | 1 / 1 |
| Annual/quarterly filing diligence | partial | 65 / 23 |
| DFF | available | 1 / 1 |
| DGS10 | available | 1 / 1 |
| CPIAUCSL | available | 1 / 1 |
| UNRATE | available | 1 / 1 |
| Recent company news | available | 3 / 2 |
| Official policy and global news | available | 28 / 2 |
| Public discussion sample | partial | 1 / 1 |
| Insider transactions and filing references | partial | 1 / 1 |
| MT5 FX/index/gold context | available | 6 / 1 |

Inbox: awaiting_committee. Execution is off. Required coverage blockers: Income, cash flow and balance-sheet inputs: partial; Annual/quarterly filing diligence: partial; Required inputs omitted from saved worker delivery: Annual/quarterly filing diligence, Recent company news, Official policy and global news

New cycles use 20 AURORA core roles. This preserved fund edition contains 30 roles. TradingAgents remains a distinguishable 12-role research workflow.

# 01 / AURORA

30-role saved multi-asset research cycle. Patient thesis-led review across FX, indices, equities and fixed income.

## FX / WATCH

GBP/USD remains on watch. The Fed target range is 3.75-4.00%, versus Bank Rate at 3.75%; these are distinct settings. Expected policy paths and risk flows remain unresolved.

Countercase: Persistent UK inflation could support GBP, while softer UK data or demand for dollar liquidity could favour USD. A Treasury yield gap alone does not measure expected tightening.

Next check: Read the UK releases with observation periods and revisions; compare fresh FX, front-end yields and volatility. Do not label a surprise without verified expectations data.

Federal Reserve primary document / Federal Reserve issues FOMC statement / Wed, 16 Sep 2026 18:00:00 GMT

FRED / DFEDTARL / 2026-10-17

FRED / DFEDTARU / 2026-10-17

## Index / WATCH

Nasdaq-100 remains on watch. Strong reported AI-memory earnings coincided with weaker share prices. The desk withdrew its earlier claim that this established cycle-peak pricing.

Countercase: Cyclical repricing could explain the move without a systemic shock. An earlier VIX reading cannot verify conditions during the later equity session; index weights and valuation remain incomplete.

Next check: Read MU and NVDA working-capital and commitment notes; align the dates of yields, spreads and breadth. Treat proposed thresholds as research hypotheses.

Massive / QQQ completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

Massive / MU completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

SEC company facts / MU sourced financial comparisons / 2026-10-09

## Equity / WATCH

Micron remains a research candidate. Issuer disclosures support an AI-demand question, but receivables, customer prepayment terms and mid-cycle earnings require more work.

Countercase: A low multiple on unusually strong trailing earnings does not establish cheapness. Current demand can be strong while future earnings weaken; full company diligence is unfinished.

Next check: Use shorter literal filing searches and full-document pages for deposit terms and receivables. Complete mid-cycle earnings scenarios and assess a cost-aware instrument expression.

SEC EDGAR / MU 10-Q / requested filing_page / 2026-06-25

SEC EDGAR / MU 10-K / requested filing_search / 2026-10-09

SEC EDGAR / MU 10-K / requested filing_search / 2026-10-09

## Fixed Income / WATCH

Duration remains on watch. Treasury and TLT history justify further investigation, but do not separate expected policy changes from term premiums.

Countercase: Persistent inflation can hurt duration; weaker growth or falling term premiums can help. Neither an ETF rally nor quiet volatility settles the mechanism.

Next check: Review policy minutes and projections with date-aligned yields, breakevens, credit and ETF data. Distinguish bond cash flows from ETF or CFD price exposure.

FRED / VIXCLS history / 2026-10-15

Federal Reserve primary document primary document / FOMC minutes / Minutes of the Federal Open Market Committee, September 15-16, 2026 / Wed, 7 Oct 2026 18:00:00 GMT

FRED / DGS2 history / 2026-10-15

## Company research shortlist

MPC / energy / Is the reported Strait of Hormuz refined-product disruption a durable driver of Marathon Petroleum's crack spreads, and how much refiner upside is already reflected in price?

NVDA / technology / Does record TSMC Q3 earnings with 58% Q4 revenue growth guidance materially extend the AI-demand earnings path for high-weight names like NVDA, or is the market correctly de-rating them on duration instead?

MU / technology / Is Micron's status among 2026's best Nasdaq-100 performers an AI-memory-demand story with remaining earnings support, and does the 'gains already priced in' caution survive primary evidence?

AAPL / technology / Macro sector investigation + dated single-session capacity filter; company thesis and valuation remain unverified.

XOM / energy / Macro sector investigation + dated single-session capacity filter; company thesis and valuation remain unverified.

MSFT / technology / Macro sector investigation + dated single-session capacity filter; company thesis and valuation remain unverified.

## Committee clearance / preserved source cycle

These are the recorded committee reasons from the fund source cycle. New broker identity verification below is a separate update; the committee has not been retroactively reapproved.

DEFER: Watch/research file, not a paper candidate; no OIS strip, no verified FX mapping beyond demo history, and direction unresolvable before 20-21 Oct UK releases.

DEFER: Index watch with unverified MT5 symbol mapping; cycle-durability and expectations data missing; no paper candidate submitted.

DEFER: MU gated on uncertified full-filing review and Agent 12's mid-cycle EPS band; contract terms, costs and measured risk incomplete.

DEFER: TLT duration watch: rate path undecomposed, symbol mapping unverified, carry cost unmeasured; no paper candidate submitted.

# Broker identities / current verification

Read-only terminal verification: 2026-10-18T13:11:03.782488+00:00. Correct identity is separate from fresh quotes, measured financing, thesis diligence and position-risk approval.

| Research asset | Exact demo contract | Identity | Quote |
|---|---|---|---|
| EURUSD | EURUSD | verified | unavailable |
| GBPUSD | GBPUSD | verified | unavailable |
| USDJPY | USDJPY | verified | unavailable |
| NASDAQ100 | USTEC | verified | unavailable |
| SP500 | US500 | verified | unavailable |
| GOLD | XAUUSD | verified | unavailable |
| AAPL | AAPL.NAS | verified | unavailable |
| GOOG | GOOG.NAS | verified | unavailable |
| GOOGL | GOOGL.NAS | unavailable | unavailable |
| AMZN | AMZN.NAS | verified | unavailable |
| MU | MU.NAS | verified | unavailable |
| TLT | TLT.NAS | verified | unavailable |

Equity, ETF and index contracts listed here are CFDs, not ownership of the referenced securities. GOOGL has no exact terminal contract in the verified catalogue. GOOG.NAS is an alternative Alphabet share class, requiring its own analysis and explicit choice. No proxy was substituted.

Raw swap metadata is not a measured overnight cash cost. Historical deferrals also concern unresolved investment direction, expectations, filing reconciliation and risk. Correct mapping alone does not clear these issues.

MetaTrader 5 / Terminal symbol properties / 2026-10-18T13:11:03.782488+00:00

# Standing company watch

AAPL, GOOGL and AMZN are monitored through a separate fixed-company entry route. No AURORA shortlist selection is required; shared macro context, portfolio governance and patient holding rules are retained. At most one queued deep case is routed per daily reporting cycle.

## AAPL / complete

Research disposition only, not clearance. Verified Q3 FY26 fundamentals are strong (+16.4% revenue, 32.6% operating margin despite R&D +32%, deleveraging), but the margin beat partly reflects one-off IEEPA tariff refunds booked as products-cost reductions and MD&A warns costs will intensify. Foldable demand/delivery-slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are unverified publisher claims. At a reported ~39x against a 5.10% 10Y, the multiple embeds both open disputes.

Attention: New captured news or filing references

Yahoo Finance RSS / www.fool.com / Own VGT? Here's How Much of It Is Really Nvidia, Apple, Microsoft, and Broadcom. / 2026-10-18T13:28:00+00:00

Yahoo Finance RSS / www.tikr.com / iPhone Duo Preorders Sell Out Rapidly As Delivery Estimates Slip Into January / 2026-10-18T13:12:12+00:00

## GOOG / not started

News and filings are monitored separately from AURORA discovery; investigation remains pending.

Attention: Initial baseline investigation

Yahoo Finance RSS / www.fool.com / Prediction: Alphabet Will Report Google Cloud Revenue Growth Exceeding 100% on Oct. 28. / 2026-10-18T12:05:00+00:00

The Motley Fool / Prediction: Alphabet Will Report Google Cloud Revenue Growth Exceeding 100% on Oct. 28. / 2026-10-18T11:45:00Z

## AMZN / not started

News and filings are monitored separately from AURORA discovery; investigation remains pending.

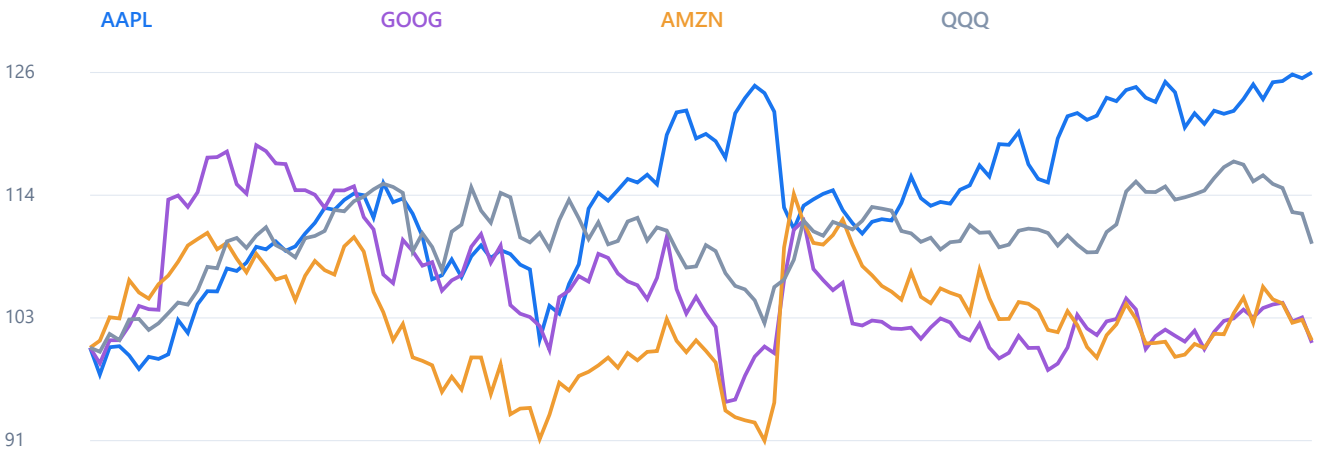
Attention: New captured news or filing references

The Motley Fool / Breakfast News: The Sunday Edition / 2026-10-18T11:30:00Z

Yahoo Finance RSS / www.fool.com / 2 Retail Stocks to Buy Before the Holiday Shopping Season / 2026-10-18T10:39:01+00:00

# Observed market comparison

Observed security price history rebased to 100 on common sessions. Vendor adjustments are not independently reconciled. These are market-price returns, not TradingAgents returns, total shareholder returns or a simulated strategy. No fees, financing, dividends or trading signals are modeled.




2026-04-20 to 2026-10-16 / 126 common completed sessions. Base 100.

Strategy returns, annualized returns, Sharpe and strategy drawdown remain unmeasured: no verified strategy NAV series is available. The researchers' published TradingAgents results are not performance of this implementation or account.

# 02 / TradingAgents

Independent company review with analyst research, bull/bear debate and risk challenge. Current case: AAPL.

## The idea-selection queue

## MU / MIXED

MU fell 5.6% in one session and 14.6% over five on China-related concerns despite bullish coverage citing forward P/E of 7 and multi-year AI agreements. The fresh 10-K permits primary verification of China revenue share, HBM pricing, and customer concentration before treating the pullback as overreaction or cycle-peak signal.

Opposing case: Memory is cyclical: 358% 12-month gains may embed peak-cycle pricing. If China restrictions hit sales or HBM supply normalizes in 2027, consensus estimates and the low P/E multiple could both compress further.

Next check: Read the 10-K Item 1 and risk factors for China revenue disclosure, export-control exposure, and HBM customer agreements; then compare against the claimed 31% sequential growth and fiscal 2027 commitments.

Massive / MU completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

Massive / If I Had to Pick 1 Tech Stock to Hold Through the Next Recession, It Would Be This One / 2026-10-17T12:20:00Z

SEC EDGAR / MU 10-K / risk factors / 2026-10-09

SEC EDGAR / MU 10-K / business / 2026-10-09

## MPC / BULLISH

Investigate whether the reported diesel disruption improves MPC refining margins. Verify the primary event, product-versus-feedstock prices and its reported refining, midstream and renewable-diesel mix before drawing an investment conclusion.

Editorial qualification: the event is a publisher-reported lead, and MPC has multiple operating segments. The original selector response is retained.

Opposing case: Disruption-driven spreads historically mean-revert when supply routes reopen; 41.8% annualized volatility and 20-session momentum suggest the market may already price the event. Higher crude costs could also compress throughput margins if product prices cap out.

Next check: Verify current diesel crack spread levels and their persistence, quantify MPC's refining margin capture in the Q3 10-Q when filed, and check whether the Q2 revenue surge reflected price or volume.

Massive / What High Diesel Prices Mean for These 5 Energy Stocks / 2026-10-17T12:30:00Z

EODHD / MPC completed-session OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

SEC EDGAR / MPC 10-Q / financial statements / 2026-08-04

SEC EDGAR / MPC 10-Q / mda / 2026-08-04

## NVDA / WATCH

Two specific supplied triggers warrant investigation rather than a stance: the Gartner report projecting 80% of neocloud failures by 2030 raises demand-concentration questions for GPU vendors, and the $11.9B Hugging Face acquisition 8-K signals a strategic platform shift whose revenue model is undefined. Both bear on the durability of data-center capex assumptions.

Opposing case: Neocloud weakness may not impair NVDA if hyperscaler demand dominates; the Hugging Face deal is small relative to revenue and closes in 2027, so near-term financial impact may be minimal and the market reaction noise.

Next check: Identify NVDA's disclosed customer and neocloud revenue concentration in the next 10-K/10-Q, and review the Hugging Face 8-K's stated revenue-recognition treatment and integration costs ahead of the expected first-half 2027 close.

Massive / Neocloud Stock Collapse: Buying Opportunity or Run for the Hills? / 2026-10-17T11:30:00Z

SEC EDGAR / NVDA 8-K / item 8 01 / 2026-09-03

# The independent analyst review

## Market analyst / WATCH

AAPL set a record close (~$343.46) with constructive momentum: RSI14 62.1, MACD above signal, price above rising 20/50/200-day averages. Trend is intact but stretched: press-cited P/E near 39 against a 5.1% 10-year yield leaves little valuation cushion. Foldable iPhone backlog slipping deliveries into January is a live earnings-transmission question ahead of the Nov 2 report.

Trend (as of 2026-10-16 session): close ~343 sits above EMA10 339.9, SMA20 337.4, SMA50 325.7 and SMA200 292.5 — a stacked bullish alignment with price near the upper Bollinger band (345.6), signaling extended short-term positioning rather than a fresh breakout. RSI14 62.1 is strong but not overbought; MACD 4.13 vs signal 3.94 with a small positive histogram (+0.20) indicates momentum that is still improving but decelerating at the margin. ATR14 ~6.7 (~2% of price) implies a normal-day range that can move the stock through the mid-band quickly; the band top is a nearer reference than the 200-day (~15% below). Volume context is unavailable in my packet, so any accumulation/divergence read is unverified — VWMA20 (337.7) matching SMA20 suggests no obvious distortion, but that is weak evidence. Catalyst path: feeds report the $1,999 foldable sold out with deliveries slipping to late January, and a Nov 2 earnings date. Falsifiable question: does the January delivery slip push foldable revenue from the December quarter into the March quarter, reshaping two consecutive reports? That is checkable against segment/product disclosure and guidance, not headlines. Macro cross-check: DGS10 at 5.10% with a 2.35% 10-year breakeven leaves a ~2.75% real yield — a high hurdle for a 39x earnings mega-cap; VIX 16.5 shows no stress premium, consistent with complacent risk conditions. Fundamentals are genuinely strong (June-Q revenue $109.4B, +16% y/y; operating margin ~33%), supporting the trend, but the multiple embeds much of it. Rate direction is the key second-order risk: further long-end yield rise compresses the multiple independently of earnings.

Countercase: Bear case: RSI 62 with price pinned near the upper band after a record close is late-trend positioning; a foldable delivery slip into January could shift revenue out of the December quarter and disappoint at the Nov 2 print while the multiple is rich and the 10Y at 5.1% offers a competing risk-free yield. An earnings miss or cautious guidance could unwind gains fast given the thin valuation cushion.

Next check: Read the FY Q4 (Sept-26) 10-K/press release on Nov 2 for foldable product revenue timing and December-quarter guidance; cross-check daily AAPL volume on rally days vs the 20-day average to confirm or refute accumulation behind the record close.

Evidence gap: No share-volume history delivered in my packet; accumulation/divergence reads are unverified.

Evidence gap: Foldable revenue timing and December-quarter guidance are headline claims, not yet filing-verified ahead of the Nov 2 report.

AURORA technical calculations / AAPL dated RSI, MACD and moving averages / 2026-10-16

Yahoo Finance / AAPL Yahoo company-news feed / 2026-10-18T09:00:00+00:00

Massive company news / AAPL recent company-news search / 2026-10-18T11:30:00Z

## Fundamentals analyst / WATCH

AAPL's Q3 FY26 shows 16% sales growth, 50% gross margin, $101B nine-month net income, and net-cash balance sheet with $62B in buybacks. But the margin jump is partly tariff-refund accounting, and management explicitly warns intensifying component-cost inflation. Quality of the margin expansion is the open question; no valuation call without current price data.

Q3 FY26 (June 27): revenue $109.4B (+16.4% y/y), products +18%, services +12%. Nine-month gross margin 49.0% vs 46.8%; Q3 products gross margin ~40.1% vs ~34.5% a year ago — an unusually large expansion. Mechanisms: (1) Supreme Court struck down IEEPA tariffs in Feb 2026; Apple recognized refunds as reductions of products cost of sales, so part of the improvement is non-recurring; (2) services mix; (3) pricing. R&D is up 32% y/y ($34.0B nine months), consistent with the Siri AI/iOS 27 investment cycle flagged in MD&A, yet operating margin still expanded to 32.6%. Balance-sheet flags: inventories nearly doubled ($5.7B to $11.1B) — plausibly component pre-buying against the stated semiconductor/NAND/DRAM supply constraints, worth verifying; intangibles rose $9B. Debt reduced (commercial paper $8B to $2B, term repayments, no issuance) while buybacks continued from operating cash flow — financing activity is deleveraging plus capital return, not necessity. Macro context cuts both ways: fed funds 3.75-4.00% with the 10-year at 5.1% (largely real yield, 2.78% 10y TIPS) is a demanding discount-rate backdrop; credit spreads are tight (IG 105bp), so no funding stress. MD&A language — cost trends 'expected to intensify,' price increases may not fully mitigate — is a direct forward warning against extrapolating Q3 margin. Hypothesis to falsify: products margin expansion is mostly one-off refunds and will compress as Section 301 tariffs and memory costs bite in FY27.

Countercase: Bulls can argue margin gains reflect durable pricing power and services mix, AI features could drive a hardware upgrade cycle, and the refund tailwind persists while claims are processed; R&D scaling may not compress operating margin given 16% revenue growth.

Next check: Read the 10-Q MD&A gross-margin discussion (mda section, offset ~6000) to quantify tariff-refund recognition and product/services margin drivers, plus search 'refund' to size the one-off.

Evidence gap: No current price/valuation data in packet; P/E and implied expectations unassessable

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude and inventory-build purpose not yet quantified in filing

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_page / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_page / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

## News analyst / WATCH

AAPL news cycle is dominated by an unverified CEO transition to John Ternus, a $1,999 foldable iPhone selling out with January delivery slips, and a reported $250M Siri settlement. A record ~$343 close and ~39x P/E sit against a 5.1% 10-year yield and market-implied Fed hikes. Earnings Nov 2 is the next hard catalyst. Stance: watch, not act.

All company items are secondary publisher summaries, unverified against primary filings. Factual anchors: FY2025 10-K shows $112.0B net income, $90.7B buybacks, $15.4B dividends — capital-return machinery intact. The 'Ternus' literal search on the 2026-07-30 8-K returned zero matches; a literal miss does not disprove the appointment, but the transition, the foldable sell-out/backlog and the Siri settlement remain hypotheses, not facts. Economic transmission to test: (1) foldable demand at $1,999 shifts revenue mix toward high-ASP hardware and could pull December-quarter revenue forward or shift it into January deliveries — which of two consecutive quarters absorbs it matters for consensus; (2) the Siri settlement raises product-delay litigation as a recurring cost of AI execution; (3) paid/premium Siri AI would be a services-mix tailwind but is only analyst speculation. Valuation is the binding mechanism: ~39x earnings with the 10-year at 5.1% (real 10y ~2.78%) means the equity carries heavy duration risk; Polymarket prices ~68.5% on two 2026 hikes, so multiple compression, not earnings, is the main downside channel. VIX at 16.5 shows no stress; risk is complacency into a hiked-rate regime, not funding. The Nov 2 report tests whether foldable backlog and home-category launches show up in guidance; record-close positioning implies high expectations bar.

Countercase: Bulls argue ecosystem depth plus foldable supercycle justify 39x regardless of rates, and Ternus continuity plus Home/LG partnerships extend services growth. If the 10-year's rise reflects growth/term premium rather than policy surprise, duration drag on mega-cap cash generators is smaller than the hiking narrative implies.

Next check: Search latest 10-Q/8-K for 'Siri', 'foldable' and 'Ternus' to verify settlement, product and transition in primary text; confirm foldable delivery slip via Apple order/newsroom; pull Q4 guidance and earnings-date 8-K before Nov 2.

Evidence gap: CEO transition, foldable sell-out/backlog and $250M Siri settlement are unverified publisher claims absent from searched filing text so far

Evidence gap: No verified consensus or positioning data; multiple-compression risk at 39x is a hypothesis, not measured

Yahoo Finance / AAPL Yahoo company-news feed / 2026-10-18T09:00:00+00:00

Massive company news / AAPL recent company-news search / 2026-10-18T11:30:00Z

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 8-K / requested filing_search / 2026-07-30

## Sentiment analyst / WATCH

Delivered social and news feeds show a mildly bullish tone around a record close (~$343.46, publisher-reported) and strong launch narrative (foldable iPhone sellout, HomeView, new CEO Ternus) ahead of the Nov 2 report. StockTwits sample is small, mixed and unrepresentative; the empty Reddit pull is not neutral sentiment. No representative positioning or verified consensus exists. Stance: watch, not trade-ready.

Facts vs claims: (1) Yahoo ticker-feed headlines (publisher summaries, unverified) report a record close at $343.46, a $1,999 foldable iPhone that 'sold out' with January delivery slippage, a HomeView Siri AI device launch, CEO transition to John Ternus, and a Nov 2 earnings date. These are secondary publisher claims, not verified issuer disclosures; the sellout/demand claim in particular needs confirmation against Apple's own statements or channel checks. (2) SEC 10-Q risk factors (period ended 2026-06-27) confirm single/limited-source component dependence — a primary fact relevant to any launch-driven demand narrative. (3) Broker feed verifies the AAPL.NAS CFD identity but quotes are stale, so no intraday price evidence is admissible from it. Social: the StockTwits sample (~20 posts, 12-18 Oct) is dominated by unlabelled retail posts, Elliott Wave bullishness, and one bearish claim that 'iPhone sales down 18-20%' which is an unverified opinion, not issuer data. Labels themselves are user self-reported. Tone skews bullish-to-curious near highs with some mean-reversion anxiety; this is anecdote, not measured sentiment. Macro context is a headwind for duration-heavy mega-cap tech: DGS10 at 5.10% and DGS30 5.43% (15 Oct) with VIX 16.46 — calm volatility but elevated yields compress equity risk appetite; Fed funds target 3.75-4.00% means cuts are already priced into cash yields, so further disinflation is the transmission to watch. Second-order effect: if foldable backlog genuinely shifts revenue between quarters, Nov 2 guidance becomes the falsifiable event for the sellout claim. Empty Reddit feed reflects a bounded query failure, not sentiment.

Countercase: The bullish tone rests on publisher demand claims (sellout, record close) and retail hype at all-time highs — classic crowding risk. An unverified retail claim of 18-20% iPhone unit decline, if partially true, would contradict the launch euphoria; elevated 10-year yields (5.1%) can de-rate even calm-name mega-caps despite low VIX.

Next check: Search AAPL news feed for issuer-sourced confirmation of foldable sellout/delivery slippage and any pre-earnings guidance language before the Nov 2 report; retry filing_search with a short query ('foldable') if zero matches.

Evidence gap: No verified issuer confirmation of foldable iPhone demand or delivery-slip claims; all demand evidence is secondary publisher summary

Evidence gap: Small, unlabelled StockTwits sample and empty Reddit pull; no representative sentiment or consensus strip available

Yahoo Finance / AAPL Yahoo company-news feed / 2026-10-18T09:00:00+00:00

StockTwits / AAPL public discussion sample / 2026-10-18T12:36:45+00:00

Reddit / AAPL public discussion sample / 2026-10-18T13:18:07.720300+00:00

## Bull researcher / BULLISH

Bull case on AAPL: verified Q3 FY26 fundamentals show 16.4% revenue growth to $109.4B, ~49-50% gross margin and 32.6% operating margin even while absorbing a 32% R&D increase — evidence of genuine pricing power, not just accounting. Record close $343.46 with intact stacked trend; valuation risk at ~39x vs 5.1% 10Y is real but partly offset by net

cash, deleveraging and massive buybacks.

Verified facts (Q3 FY26 10-Q, quarter ended 2026-06-27): revenue $109.4B, +16.4% y/y, products +18%, services +12%; nine-month gross margin 49.0% vs 46.8%; operating margin 32.6% despite R&D up 32% y/y to $34.0B — margin expanded while Apple funded the Siri/AI investment cycle, contradicting the bear claim that growth is bought. Balance sheet: commercial paper cut $8B to $2B, no debt issuance, buybacks funded from operating cash flow — capital return is not financed, and net cash cushions multiple-compression risk. Hypothesis vs fact: the margin beat is partly one-off tariff refunds (post-IEEPA ruling), so extrapolation is wrong; but even stripping that, mix shift to services and pricing power are durable. The foldable iPhone sellout/January backlog is an unverified publisher claim, yet its transmission is plausible and checkable: a $1,999 high-ASP product pulling demand into two consecutive quarters. Market context: AAPL +37.7% over 252 sessions, +28.3% over 120, above rising 20/50/200-day MAs, RSI14 62 — strong trend with room, not yet overbought; record close held on 1.56x average volume with QQQ -2.5% the same session, i.e., AAPL outperformed a tech drawdown — relative strength, not just beta. Rates: 10Y at 5.10% is a hurdle, but T10Y2Y +0.35 and breakevens ~2.35% mean much of the rise is real yield/term premium rather than policy shock; cash yields (3.75-4.00% target) already embed the hiking path, and VIX 16.46 with IG spreads 105bp shows no stress. A net-cash mega-cap with 16% growth and buyback support is less duration-sensitive than high-multiple growth peers. Weaknesses in bear reports: '39x with no cushion' ignores that earnings, not just price, moved (+37.7% price vs high-20s trailing EPS revision path); the inventory doubling ($5.7B to $11.1B) is consistent with disclosed single-source component pre-buying ahead of demand, not channel stuffing — falsifiable in cash flow.

Countercase: If margin expansion is mostly tariff refunds and foldable revenue slips out of the December quarter, Nov 2 guidance disappoints at a rich multiple near the upper Bollinger band; component-cost warnings ('expected to intensify') and 5.1% 10Y could force both EPS and multiple cuts.

Next check: filing_search AAPL 10-Q for 'refund' to size the tariff-refund one-off in products margin, and read MD&A gross-margin discussion; then verify foldable demand/backlog against the Nov 2 earnings release and December-quarter guidance.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin not yet quantified from the MD&A; margin-quality conclusion is partly inference.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/backlog and CEO transition remain unverified publisher claims; no primary Apple confirmation in searched filings yet.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / risk factors / 2026-07-31

Massive / AAPL completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

AURORA technical calculations / AAPL dated RSI, MACD and moving averages / 2026-10-16

## Bear researcher / BEARISH

Bear case: AAPL at record ~$343 (~39x) faces a 5.10% 10Y (2.78% real). Q3 margin expansion is partly non-recurring tariff refunds, MD&A warns intensifying component costs, inventories doubled, and an unverified foldable delivery slip could push revenue out of the December quarter into the Nov 2 report. Rich multiple plus decelerating margin quality is the downside channel.

Facts (Q3 FY26 10-Q): revenue $109.4B (+16.4%), nine-month gross margin 49.0% vs 46.8%, operating margin 32.6%, R&D +32% y/y. But part of the margin jump is one-off tariff refunds after the IEEPA ruling, booked as cost reductions; the refund base makes FY27 comps mechanically harder. MD&A explicitly warns cost trends are 'expected to intensify' and price increases may not fully offset. The 10-Q discloses single/limited-source component dependence; inventories nearly doubled ($5.7B to $11.1B) — a pre-buy that unwinds as write-downs or demand risk if launches slip. Memory-price volatility is visible: MU fell 5.6% on Oct 16. Hypothesis: products margin compresses in FY27 as refunds exhaust and DRAM/NAND inflation bites — the market is not pricing this at 39x. Expectations: record close $343.46 near the upper Bollinger band (345.6), +37.7% over 252 sessions, RSI 62 — a high bar. Rates transmission: DGS10 5.10% with 2.78% real yield and funds at 3.75-4.00% with market-implied hikes compress the multiple independent of earnings; QQQ fell 5.5% over five sessions on 1.9x volume — a tech de-rate is underway. First-order effect: a foldable delivery slip into January shifts high-ASP revenue out of the December quarter, disappointing Nov 2 guidance. Second-order: refund-driven margin deceleration plus inventory normalization cut both EPS and the multiple — the classic double-hit for a duration-heavy mega-cap at cycle-high

positioning.

Countercase: Net cash, deleveraging and ~$90B buybacks cushion multiple compression; pricing power and services mix may be durable, not refund-driven. If the 10Y rise is term premium rather than policy surprise, duration drag shrinks, and an AI/foldable upgrade cycle could lift both EPS and multiple.

Next check: Run filing_search on AAPL 10-Q for 'refund' and read the MD&A gross-margin discussion to quantify the one-off tariff-refund contribution; then verify foldable delivery timing against the Nov 2 earnings release and December-quarter guidance before judging the comp math.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin not yet quantified from filing text; margin-quality conclusion is partly inference.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/backlog and December-quarter revenue timing are publisher claims, not issuer-verified.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / risk factors / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / risk factors / 2026-05-01

Massive / AAPL completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

## Research manager / BALANCED

Adjudication: AAPL's Q3 FY26 fundamentals are verified and strong (revenue +16.4%, 49% nine-month gross margin, deleveraging, buybacks from operating cash flow), but the margin jump is partly non-recurring tariff refunds and management warns of intensifying component costs. Foldable sellout/backlog, CEO transition and Siri settlement remain unverified publisher claims. At ~39x vs a 5.10% 10Y, valuation embeds both debates.

Verified facts: 10-Q (period 2026-06-27) confirms revenue $109.4B (+16.4% y/y), products +18%, services +12%, nine-month gross margin 49.0% vs 46.8%, R&D +32%, commercial paper cut $8B to $2B. The same 10-Q confirms a Supreme Court IEEPA ruling with tariff refunds booked as reductions of products cost of sales, and Section 301/232 tariff risk ahead; the FY25 10-K already showed tariff costs pressuring product margins. Hypotheses, not facts: (1) bull claim that pricing power and services mix alone drove margin gains; (2) bear claim that refunds dominate and FY27 comps compress as memory costs bite; the refund magnitude is not yet quantified, so margin quality is unresolved. Inventories doubling ($5.7B to $11.1B) is consistent with single-source component pre-buying but is falsifiable via cash flow and worth checking, not assuming channel stuffing. Market expectations: record ~$343 close, press-cited ~39x P/E, against DGS10 5.10% and a 2.78% 10-year real yield; VIX 16.5 and tight IG spreads show calm, not stress. The foldable story (sellout, January delivery slip) would shift high-ASP revenue between the December and March quarters — a transmission that changes two consecutive reports — but it appears only in secondary feeds, and the July 8-K 'foldable' search returned zero matches (a literal miss, not disproof). First-order effects: refund exhaustion and component inflation on gross margin; foldable timing on quarterly revenue. Second-order: multiple compression at a rich multiple if either lands badly, partially cushioned by net cash and buybacks. I preserve the bull/bear split rather than forcing consensus: the disagreement hinges on refund size and December-quarter guidance.

Countercase: Bears could be wrong if refunds are small and margin strength is durable pricing power plus services mix; bulls could be wrong if the foldable backlog slips revenue out of the December quarter while 'intensifying' memory costs compress product margin, delivering an EPS and multiple double-hit at cycle-high positioning.

Next check: Quantify the tariff-refund contribution via filing_page on the 10-Q MD&A gross-margin discussion (full_document with match offsets around the 'refund' hits), and check cash-flow inventory build; then verify foldable demand and December-quarter guidance in the Nov 2 FY26 10-K/earnings release before resolving the margin-quality dispute.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin is unquantified; margin-quality conclusion remains inference for both bull and bear cases.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are secondary publisher claims, absent from searched primary filing text so far.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-K / requested filing_page / 2025-10-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 8-K / requested filing_search / 2026-07-30

# Trader / WATCH

AAPL watch, conditional on the Nov 2 FY26 Q4 report. Verified: strong Q3 FY26 fundamentals (+16.4% revenue, ~49% nine-month gross margin, deleveraging, buybacks from operating cash flow), but margin gains partly reflect one-off tariff refunds and MD&A warns of intensifying component costs. Unverified publisher claims (foldable sellout/January delivery slip, CEO transition, Siri settlement) are leads, not facts.

Research question: is Q3 FY26 margin expansion durable pricing power, or one-off tariff refunds that reverse in FY27? Primary filing confirms the mechanism: the 10-Q states the Supreme Court struck down IEEPA tariffs and refunds are recognized as reductions of products cost of sales, while Section 301/232 tariff risk persists; the FY25 10-K already showed tariff costs pressuring product margins. The refund magnitude is not yet quantified, so margin quality is unresolved — this is the core open dispute, not a reason to act. Hypothesis vs fact: foldable sellout and January delivery slip would shift high-ASP revenue between December and March quarters, reshaping two consecutive reports, but it appears only in secondary feeds (a 'foldable' filing search returned zero literal matches, which does not disprove anything). Market expectations: record ~$343 close with stacked bullish trend, RSI ~62 near the upper band — strong momentum with a high expectations bar. Valuation: ~39x vs DGS10 5.10% and ~2.78% real yield is a demanding discount-rate backdrop; VIX ~16.5 and tight IG spreads show calm, not stress, so risk is complacency at cycle-high positioning. First-order effects: refund exhaustion and memory-cost inflation on gross margin; foldable timing on quarterly revenue. Second-order: an EPS-and-multiple double-hit if both land badly, cushioned by net cash and ~$90B annual buybacks. Balanced stance: fundamentals are genuinely strong, but the rich multiple embeds both the margin-quality and foldable-timing debates. Resolution requires the Nov 2 release, not further extrapolation from headlines.

Countercase: Bears may be wrong: even stripping refunds, services mix and pricing power are durable, inventories doubling is consistent with disclosed single-source component pre-buying, and the 10Y rise is largely real yield/term premium rather than a policy shock — reducing duration drag on a net-cash cash generator.

Next check: On Nov 2, read the FY26 Q4 earnings release/10-K for quantified tariff-refund contribution, December-quarter guidance and foldable revenue timing; verify or retire the delivery-slip claim. Before then, quantify refunds via filing_page full_document offset ~35900 of the 10-Q.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin unquantified; margin-quality conclusion is inference.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement remain unverified publisher claims.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-K / requested filing_page / 2025-10-31

Yahoo Finance / AAPL Yahoo company-news feed / 2026-10-18T09:00:00+00:00

# Opportunity risk analyst / WATCH

Strongest exposure case rests on verified Q3 FY26 fundamentals (+16.4% revenue, 32.6% operating margin despite R&D +32%) and intact trend, not the unverified foldable hype. Opportunity cost of waiting is modest: the Nov 2 catalyst is hard-dated ~15 days out and cheaply resolves the two open disputes (refund magnitude, December guidance). Condition exposure on the print; do not pre-position on publisher demand claims.

Fact versus claim: the 10-Q verifies revenue $109.4B (+16.4% y/y), products +18%, services +12%, and operating margin 32.6% while absorbing a 32% R&D increase — evidence of genuine operating leverage, and commercial paper was cut $8B to $2B, so capital return is not financed. What is NOT verified: the foldable sellout/January delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement; these appear only in secondary feeds and the 'foldable' filing search returned zero literal matches (a miss, not disproof). Exposure case built on launch euphoria is therefore resting on unassessed leads. The core bull case does not need the foldable story; the bear case does need the tariff refund to be large — that asymmetry favors some exposure, but timing matters. Opportunity cost of waiting: with a dated catalyst, the information purchase costs roughly two weeks; if guidance confirms durable margin and high-ASP mix, entry post-print will likely be dearer, and the 120-session +28.3%/252-session +37.7% advance shows momentum regimes can run into earnings. Against that: the record $343.46 close sits near the upper band on 1.56x average volume — one session of relative volume is not independent confirmation

of accumulation — and ~39x against a 5.10% 10Y (2.78% real) means the current price already discounts delivery; the marginal buyer needs the bar cleared, not just held. The January-slip claim is sign-ambiguous (demand strength vs revenue timing) and must not be used either way until issuer-confirmed. First-order risks: refund exhaustion and 'intensifying' memory costs compressing products margin; second-order: multiple compression independent of earnings, only partly cushioned by net cash. My challenge to the proposed 'watch': waiting is correct, but only because the catalyst is near and dated — the same wait in February would carry far higher opportunity cost. If pre-print exposure is taken at all, it should be sized for a guidance disappointment, not scaled to the hype cycle.

Countercase: Waiting could cost real money if margin quality is durable: if refunds are small and pricing power/services mix drove the beat, the stock re-rates before Nov 2 and the watch stance pays 10-15% more for identical information. Momentum plus buyback support frequently carries verified-growth names through print dates.

Next check: Before Nov 2: filing_page full_document offset ~35900 on the June-27 10-Q to size the tariff-refund contribution to products margin. On Nov 2: read December-quarter guidance and any foldable/revenue-timing disclosure; verify or retire the delivery-slip claim against issuer text.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin is unquantified; the margin-durability dispute is unresolved inference.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are secondary publisher claims with no issuer confirmation.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

Massive / AAPL completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

FRED / DGS10 / 2026-10-15

## Defensive risk analyst / WATCH

Defensive challenge: AAPL's exposure case rests partly on unverified publisher claims (foldable sellout, CEO transition) and a margin beat inflated by one-off tariff refunds. The only verified tradable vehicle is an AAPL CFD with negative long carry and no execution eligibility. At ~39x versus a 5.10% 10Y and QQQ de-rating on 1.9x volume, the pre-earnings risk asymmetry is unfavorable; do not pre-position.

Source quality is the first defect: the foldable sellout/January slip, Ternus transition and Siri settlement appear only in secondary publisher feeds; the June-27 10-Q risk factors confirm single/limited-source component dependence — a primary fact that makes launch-dependent demand narratives structurally fragile. Permanent-loss channel: margin quality. Q3's 32.6% operating margin includes tariff refunds booked as cost reductions; MD&A explicitly warns costs will 'intensify' and price rises may not offset. If refunds dominate, FY27 comps force both EPS and multiple down — the double-hit. Inventories doubled ($5.7B to $11.1B); pre-buy inventory at cycle-high positioning unwinds as write-downs if demand slips. Valuation/discount-rate channel: DGS10 5.10% with 2.78% real yield is a severe hurdle for ~39x; a yield rise compresses the multiple independent of earnings. Correlation risk: QQQ fell 5.5% over five sessions on 1.9x volume while AAPL printed a record close — relative strength is one session, not an independent vote; AAPL remains the same duration trade and a tech de-rate would drag it. Liquidity/vehicle risk: the verified broker contract is AAPL.NAS, a share CFD — swap_long -5.98 per lot, stale quotes, execution not enabled; any hypothetical position carries financing drag, gap risk through the Nov 2 print, and broker counterparty exposure, not share ownership. Missing controls: coverage shows financials and filing diligence partial, identity evidence undelivered; the refund magnitude is unquantified, so margin-quality conclusions from both bull and bear camps remain inference. No position should precede quantification of the refund and December-quarter guidance.

Countercase: If refunds prove small and services mix plus pricing power drove margins, the stock re-rates before Nov 2 and waiting costs 10-15%. Net cash and buybacks cushion compression, and the 10Y rise is largely real yield/term premium rather than a policy shock, shrinking duration drag.

Next check: filing_page on the June-27 10-Q MD&A (full_document, offset near 'refund' hits) to size the tariff-refund contribution to products margin; then read the Nov 2 FY26 Q4 release for December-quarter guidance and foldable revenue timing before any exposure decision.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin unquantified from filing text; margin-quality dispute unresolved.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/delivery slip and CEO transition remain unverified secondary publisher claims with no issuer confirmation.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / risk factors / 2026-07-31

FRED / DGS10 / 2026-10-15

Massive / QQQ completed-session equity OHLCV history / 2026-10-16

## Balanced risk analyst / BALANCED

Both bull and bear cases share the same verified anchor: Q3 FY26 revenue +16.4% and ~49% nine-month gross margin, but they split on margin QUALITY. The 10-Q confirms IEEPA tariff refunds were booked as reductions of products cost of sales — a non-recurring tailwind — while Section 301/232 tariff risk and 'intensifying' component costs persist. Refund magnitude is unquantified, so the margin-durability dispute is unresolved inference.

The bull and bear cases disagree on three identifiable assumptions, not on facts. (1) Refund share of margin: the 10-Q mechanism is verified — the Supreme Court struck down IEEPA tariffs in February 2026 and refunds were recognized as reductions of products cost of sales; the FY25 10-K's zero matches for 'refund' confirm this is a FY26 phenomenon. If refunds are large, FY27 comps compress mechanically; if small, pricing power and services mix are durable. No filing text in the packet sizes the refund. (2) Inventory build: both sides accept inventories doubled ($5.7B to $11.1B), but interpret it oppositely — pre-buying against disclosed single/limited-source component dependence (bull) versus unwinding write-down risk (bear). Cash-flow disclosure settles this. (3) Foldable timing: the January delivery slip would shift high-ASP revenue from the December to March quarter, reshaping two consecutive reports, but it is an unverified publisher claim; zero 'foldable' matches in filings is a literal miss, not disproof. Neither side may use it until issuer-confirmed. Valuation context cuts through both: DGS10 5.10% with a ~2.78% 10-year real yield is a demanding hurdle for a ~39x mega-cap, but the bull is correct that most of the rise is real yield/term premium rather than an immediate policy shock, and net cash plus buybacks from operating cash flow cushion compression. VIX at 16.5 and tight IG spreads show calm, not stress — the risk is complacency at cycle-high positioning, and one strong AAPL session against a weak QQQ is relative strength but not an independent vote. First-order effects: refund exhaustion and memory-cost inflation on products margin; foldable timing on quarterly revenue. Second-order: an EPS-and-multiple double-hit if both land badly. My risk judgment: the asymmetry is genuinely two-sided and the dispute is cheaply settled by a dated catalyst ~15 days out; pre-positioning transfers either upside opportunity cost or downside gap risk through the print.

Countercase: If I am wrong to stay balanced: small refunds plus durable pricing power re-rate the stock before Nov 2 and waiting costs 10-15%. Conversely, if refunds dominate and the foldable slips, the double-hit lands at the upper Bollinger band with a 5.1% 10Y — larger than either single risk.

Next check: filing_page full_document on the June-27 10-Q at offset ~35700 (the 'refund' match region) to quantify the tariff-refund contribution to products gross margin; then read cash-flow inventory detail. On Nov 2, verify December-quarter guidance and foldable revenue timing against issuer text.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin unquantified; margin-quality conclusions remain inference for both camps.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/January delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are secondary publisher claims with no issuer confirmation.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-K / requested filing_page / 2025-10-31

## Portfolio manager / WATCH

Research disposition only, not clearance. Verified Q3 FY26 fundamentals are strong (+16.4% revenue, 32.6% operating margin despite R&D +32%, deleveraging), but the margin beat partly reflects one-off IEEPA tariff refunds booked as products-cost reductions and MD&A warns costs will intensify. Foldable demand/delivery-slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement are unverified publisher claims.

Fact base from primary filings: the June-27 10-Q confirms revenue $109.4B (+16.4% y/y), nine-month gross margin 49.0% vs 46.8%, commercial paper cut $8B to $2B, and — critically — that the Supreme Court struck down IEEPA tariffs with refunds recognized as reductions of products cost of sales, while Section 301/232 tariff exposure persists. The refund magnitude is

unquantified, so the bull/bear split on margin durability is unresolved inference on both sides: bulls assume pricing power and services mix, bears assume refund dominance plus memory-cost inflation. Inventories doubling ($5.7B to $11.1B) is consistent with disclosed single/limited-source component dependence but is falsifiable via cash flow, not settled. The foldable sellout/January delivery slip is sign-ambiguous (demand strength vs revenue timing between December and March quarters) and appears only in secondary feeds; zero literal 'foldable' matches in filings is a miss, not disproof, and cannot be used either way. Market expectations: record ~$343 close, stacked trend, RSI ~62 near the upper band, and one session of AAPL relative strength against a QQQ 5-session -5.5% de-rate on ~1.9x volume — relative strength is context, not an independent vote. Discount-rate backdrop is demanding: DGS10 5.10% with ~2.78% real yield and a 3.75-4.00% funds target; VIX 16.5 and tight IG spreads show calm, so the risk is complacency at cycle-high positioning, with multiple compression as the main downside channel, partly cushioned by net cash and operating-cash-flow-funded buybacks. My PM dissent from the bull camp: do not treat momentum plus hype as evidence of durable margin; dissent from the bear camp: do not assume refunds dominate without quantification. The FY25 10-K search showing no refund disclosure confirms this is a FY26 phenomenon, but neither size nor FY27 comp math is established.

Countercase: If refunds prove small and services mix plus pricing power drove the beat, the stock re-rates before Nov 2 and waiting costs real money. Conversely, if refunds dominate and the foldable slips, an EPS-plus-multiple double-hit lands at the upper band with a 5.1% 10Y.

Next check: Quantify the tariff-refund contribution via filing_page full_document on the June-27 10-Q near the ~35900 refund-match offsets, plus cash-flow inventory detail; then read the Nov 2 FY26 Q4 release for December-quarter guidance and any foldable revenue-timing disclosure.

Evidence gap: Tariff-refund magnitude in products gross margin unquantified; margin-durability conclusion is inference for both camps.

Evidence gap: Foldable sellout/delivery slip, CEO transition and Siri settlement remain secondary publisher claims with no issuer confirmation.

SEC EDGAR / AAPL 10-Q / requested filing_search / 2026-07-31

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# MT5 demo / separately recorded results

Broker-recorded demo deals plus floating profit and accrued swap. Equal virtual starting allocations; no external cash flows. Curves start at 100. Pending/ambiguous orders or stale position quotes withhold new NAV. CFD demo results are not live returns. Stop losses may gap. Broker-unallocated balance charges are not attributed.

Demo runtime check: 2026-10-18T14:47:50.290089+00:00

Runtime gap: Turn on Algo Trading in the MT5 demo terminal

## TradingAgents · Megacap

Recorded return: 0.0%. Broker deals: 0. Open owned positions: 0.

Realized P&L: 0 GBP. Floating P&L and accrued swap: 0 GBP.

Demo universe: AAPL.NAS, AMZN.NAS, GOOG.NAS

## AURORA · Global

Recorded return: 0.0%. Broker deals: 0. Open owned positions: 0.

Realized P&L: 0 GBP. Floating P&L and accrued swap: 0 GBP.

Demo universe: EURUSD, GBPUSD, USDJPY, USTEC, US500, TLT.NAS, MU.NAS

The Windows MT5 runtime must remain running. Entries require Algo Trading, fresh quotes, current research, a structured proposal, a dedicated strategy risk approval and deterministic broker checks. The six-hour ordinary holding minimum does not force a timed exit. Protective broker stops may execute earlier.

Demo risk settings: maximum 0.5% strategy risk per entry, 2% total stop risk, 25% account margin; two daily ATR stop, seven daily-equivalent financing debits and a 10% sizing reserve. New entries halt after a 2% daily strategy loss or 5% drawdown. These are experimental limits, not guarantees against gaps or losses.

# Before an investment

Establish the source-verified catalyst and what is already priced in.

Complete issuer, original-filing, valuation and scenario review.

Record entry conditions, thesis invalidation and the intended holding horizon.

Verify the actual broker instrument, fresh quote, spread, financing and full holding-period costs.

Obtain independent clearance and measured sizing/risk checks. Research conviction alone is insufficient.

AURORA uses a six-hour minimum ordinary hold, with earlier exits for evidenced thesis changes or protective risk conditions. No fast-trading instruction is created by a technical indicator.

## Data and research limitations

Published research snapshot; observations have different dates.

Bullish and bearish labels describe research cases, not orders or approved allocations.

Market-price comparisons show vendor history; broker-recorded demo performance is displayed separately.

Filing-page batch incomplete for AAPL, MPC, MU, XOM. Rejected page responses were not accepted as reading evidence; supporting excerpts or saved rejected responses need review. Accepted committee completion does not resolve those diligence gaps.

The report presentation was editorially reviewed; original employee research and committee decisions were preserved. The saved review record identifies the scope. Latest source-quality checks may postdate individual submissions.

The committee corrected an earlier evidence claim. Final desk responses supersede earlier wording for this briefing; original notes remain in the audit appendix.

Full company diligence is incomplete; excerpts and selected numeric checks are not certification.

No licensed positioning or verified consensus strip supplied; any public social samples are partial and unrepresentative.

Shared vendor inputs and model family limit independence. No return or trading edge has been established.

Coverage is bounded to verified issuers with supplied filing evidence and the current numerical capacity screen. It is not a whole-market scan.

Trigger counts prioritise research attention, not expected returns, confidence or investment approval.

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## Macro source links

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